



TUESDAY
AUGUST 19, 2025
SAFAR 25, 1447

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WAM

UAE'S FOREIGN AID VALUED AT OVER DH368 BILLION

The UAE's 2024-2025 winter campaign focuses on providing humanitarian aid to vulnerable communities affected by harsh winter conditions, both domestically and internationally. On World Humanitarian Day today, the UAE reiterates its pivotal role in providing timely assistance to those affected by crises worldwide. By mid-2024, the country's foreign aid had supported over one billion people, valued at more than Dh368 billion.

SEE ALSO P4

DXB unveils system to bypass passport control

AI-POWERED PASSENGER CORRIDOR IS WORLD'S FIRST

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai International Airport (DXB), already the busiest hub for international travel, has introduced what is being described as the world's first artificial intelligence-powered passenger corridor, a system designed to allow travellers to bypass traditional passport control entirely. Lieutenant General Mohammad Ahmad Al Marri, Director General of the General Directorate for Identity and Foreigners Affairs in Dubai, announced the launch over the weekend, calling it a "quantum leap in the world of smart travel."

The corridor, dubbed the 'red carpet,' allows passengers to walk through in seconds without showing documents or stopping at immigration counters.

Unlike traditional checkpoints that process one passenger at a time, the system can handle up to ten travel-



It is redefining the travel experience. Dubai International Airport is not merely a transit point, but a vibrant gateway and a proud showcase for the UAE."

Lt Gen Mohammad Ahmad Al Marri

Director General of the General Directorate for Identity and Foreigners Affairs in Dubai

lers simultaneously. "This is not just aiming to improve efficiency," Al Marri said. "It is also redefining the travel experience. Dubai International Airport is not merely a transit point, but a vibrant gateway and a proud showcase for the UAE."

The new system uses artificial intelligence to recognise passenger data before they reach the corridor, automati-

cally verifying their identity and flagging suspicious cases for manual review. This doubles processing capacity while maintaining strict security standards.

Moving in record time

Mohammad Amer, a Syrian national, said he and his family were able to move "in record time, without stopping at passport counters."

Mahmoud Balu, from Canada, described the corridor as making the process "far smoother and more comfortable," while Ali Abdullah Al Sherawi, a Dubai businessman, said it offered "a level of seamlessness I haven't seen even at leading global airports like Singapore, Tokyo, or London."

While other major airports, including Heathrow in London and John F. Kennedy in New York, have experimented with automated lanes, passengers said Dubai's new system was both faster and more intuitive. "Dubai doesn't just compete, it sets the pace," Ali Sherawi said.

'Skibidi', 'delulu' added to Cambridge Dictionary

6,000 new entries also include 'tradwife'

LONDON

Words popularised by Gen Z and Gen Alpha including "skibidi", "delulu", and "tradwife" are among 6,000 new entries to the online edition of the Cambridge Dictionary over the last year, its publisher said yesterday.

Cambridge University Press said tradwife, a portmanteau of traditional wife, reflected "a growing, controversial Instagram and TikTok trend that embraces traditional gender roles".

The dictionary also took on the challenge of defining skibidi, a word popularised in online memes, as a term which had "different meanings such as cool or bad, or can be used with no real meaning".

The dictionary defined delulu, derived from the word delusional, as "believing things that are not real or true, usually because you choose to". Other new phrases include "lewk", used to describe a unique fashion look and "inspo", short for inspiration. — AFP

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Trump rules out Ukraine getting back Crimea or Nato entry

'Zelensky could end the war with Russia almost immediately if he wants to'

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump has claimed that Ukrainian leader Volodymyr Zelensky could "end the war with Russia almost immediately if he wants to."

Trump also reminded of the 2014 annexation of Crimea under the Obama administration and ruled out Ukraine's entry into Nato.

"President Zelensky of Ukraine can end the war with Russia almost immediately, if he wants to, or he can continue to fight. Remember how it started. No getting back Obama given Crimea (12 years ago, without a shot being fired!), and no going into Nato by Ukraine. Some things never change!!!," Trump wrote on Truth Social.

Zelensky, who is in Washington for talks with Trump, pushed back strongly against the temporary, short-term peace deal, stressing that the "peace must be lasting". He referred to past incidents, such as when Ukraine was forced to give up Crimea.

Zelensky wary

"And peace must be lasting. Not like it was years ago, when Ukraine was forced to give up Crimea and part of our East — part of Donbas — and Putin simply used it as a springboard for a new attack. Or when Ukraine was given so-called 'security guarantees' in 1994,



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but they didn't work," Zelensky wrote in an X post announcing his arrival in Washington.

He further asserted that Ukraine would not cede any more territory. "Crimea should not have been given up then, just as Ukrainians did not give up Kyiv, Odesa, or Kharkiv after 2022. Ukrainians are fighting for their land, for their independence. Now, our soldiers have successes in Donetsk and Sumy regions. I am confident that we will defend Ukraine, effectively guarantee security, and that our people will always be grateful to President Trump, everyone in America, and every partner and ally for their support and invaluable assistance," he added.

The Trump-Zelensky meeting comes just three days after Trump's high-stakes talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Alaska, which the US leader described as a success.

Leaders from France, Germany, the UK, Italy, and Finland are expected to attend the meeting. European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and Nato Secretary General Mark Rutte will also be part of the delegation.

— Agencies

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